

Mr. Max
Fred Meyer
Edison Brothers
He-Ro Group
Manpower
Thor Industries

Beverly Enterprises
Telebras
Lindsay Mfg.
Ann Taylor
Rubbermaid
Dana Corp.

Some shareholders, by the way, impervious to or unfamiliar with my brand of humor, wrongly took offense at this breakthrough study. We received letters from feminists who thought it demeaning to women. I wasn't picking on women. I was trying to insult everyone equally.

Actually, I was spoofing the foolish studies of quantitative analysts who try to wrap stocks in tidy little packages they declare will react similarly. We at Acorn are never—well, hardly ever—that simplistic.

In any case, three months later, in the first quarter of 1992, we duly reported the results of our sex contest. The girls won. From January 30 through April 30, with dividends included, they had returned 4.5 percent, the boys a mere 0.2 percent (the S&P 500 was up 0.8 percent). This scientific study, we presume, provided proof that will be accepted by all right-thinking people that females are superior in the field of economics.

Having settled that question, Acorn could move on to other, less serious matters.

¹No stocks named Herman, let alone Pee-Wee.

²As close as we could get, or want to get, to Patricia Bowman.

³Nui Onoue, a restaurant owner in Osaka, was in the headlines at the time, thanks to her using forged deposit certificates to defraud some major Japanese banks.